💬 Social-Emotional Health: Reading

Health · Unit 4 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · goes with the Social-Emotional Health module (CASEL 5, Self-Esteem, RULER, Feel Good Plan, Boundaries, Ethics, Bullying, Mental Health)

Name: _____

Skills for Feelings and Friendships

Social-emotional skills help us understand ourselves and get along with others. The CASEL 5 are self-awareness (knowing your feelings and strengths), self-management (handling feelings, stress and goals), social awareness (understanding others' feelings and backgrounds), relationship skills (communicating, cooperating and solving conflicts) and responsible decision-making (making safe, caring choices).

Self-esteem is how much a person values and respects themselves. It has two main parts: self-worth, the belief that you matter, and self-confidence, the belief that you can do things. Self-talk, the words we say to ourselves, can raise or lower self-esteem. Changing “I'm bad at this” to “I'm still learning this” is one way to build it.

RULER is a set of five emotion skills: Recognize, Understand, Label, Express and Regulate. Naming a feeling clearly, such as “frustrated” instead of “bad,” makes it easier to handle. The Feel Good Plan puts this into action: Pause, Identify the feeling, and Generate a list of healthy things that help, like going for a walk, listening to music or talking to someone you trust.

A boundary is a limit you set to protect yourself. One way to say no and keep the friendship is: give a compliment, state the concern, offer an alternative, and leave kindly if the person keeps pushing. Ethical values (honesty, respect, fairness, caring, responsibility and citizenship) help us decide what to do in hard situations.

Bullying is unwanted, repeated behavior that involves a power imbalance. It can be physical, verbal, social or online (cyberbullying). Bystanders can become upstanders by helping, including the target or reporting to an adult. Mental health moves along a continuum from healthy, to distress, to illness. Mental illness is common and treatable. Help is available from trusted adults, the school counselor, and the 988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline (call or text 988).

Check your reading

1. What is the difference between self-worth and self-confidence?

2. Why does labeling a feeling precisely help?

3. What makes a behavior bullying instead of a single conflict?